The KGB not only monitored the political views and attitudes of crew members and the military but also kept an eye on their morals. Drinking by officers, who unlike the sergeants and privates were housed in deck compartments rather than in the tween decks and had supplies of alcohol acquired before the departure, appeared to be commonplace aboard ship. Judging by the reports, no KGB officer had more problems with drunkenness than Major Morozov, who traveled on the dry cargo ship *Metallurg Bardin* surveilling the communications unit, headed by Lieutenant Colonel M. T. Zuiek. The unit came from Vinnytsia, the headquarters of the 43rd Missile Army, which formed the core of the Soviet ballistic missile forces dispatched to the island. Zuiek's echelon counted 264 military personnel, including thirty-seven officers and female privates on contract with the army. Morozov reported that Zuiek had set a bad example for his subordinates, as he not only engaged in drinking parties but also lived with a woman from his echelon, which undermined his ability to maintain discipline.[19]

A special challenge for the KGB were the crewmen of the ships. The KGB captain Zozulia on board the *Ilia Mechnikov* reported that crew members were extremely unhappy about the secrecy of the trip and the cancellation of shore leave. The authorities denied them the usual hard-currency allowance that they normally used in foreign ports to buy goods scarce in the Soviet Union and sell them on the black market upon their return. On board *Metallurg Bardin*, the ship's boatswain, Markovsky, got drunk and locked himself in his compartment with a woman, refusing to open the door when requested by a senior officer. The KGB officer Major Morozov largely blamed the women for what was going on. "Their conduct was extremely negative," he wrote in his report. "They did not react to the remarks of the echelon commander. When darkness fell, they had to be rounded up from various places where they were consorting with military personnel of the echelon."[20]

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